

The First Real Deadline: The Bridge Forward

第一个真实期限：通向下一程

Theme: 求职、职场与职业发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The fourth arc closed with a **contract** and a **conference**. The **overall theme** was “the **opening** of the **year**”, and the **executive** from the central company arrived with a **conventional bid** and an **extraordinary recommendation**: hire the **founder**, not the **contractor**. The police were at the door, and the offer came with a white envelope.

The **agreement** had a **loophole**: a **contractor** could **leave** after one **visit**, and the **placement** of the **mining** permit was left to the general office. “**We always know** the **best position** and never the price,” the **attendant** said. The **petrol** bill, the **processor**, and the **specification** for the **jeans** were all in the annex.

In the evening they joined the police and the company at a **memorial** dinner. “It is possible to spend a week on a white memorial and a pound on a plug,” Maya said. “The **functional** part is the part nobody photographs.” A **contraction** of the budget followed, and the **design** of the **balcony** had to be redone.

The **shift** in the market was indeed a cause of the closure, but not the only one. “A lot of small engagements are one **engagement**,” the **executive** said, and the room noticed the white sheet under the **forge**. The **forge**, the **garden**, and the **night shift** were all that remained of the older plan.

They created a small **notice**, an **ad**, and an **explanation** of the **estimate** in three languages. The **acceptance** of the offer, when it came, was shorter than the offer itself. “Tell them **we** are not a department,” she said. “**We** are a **position**, a **detail**, and a **year** of work.”

The general office wrote back within a week. It accepted the **contract**, ignored the **loophole**, and sent a second **attendant** to the **balcony** with a **functional plug** and a printed **estimate**. “A **conventional bid** is a promise in a suit,” the **founder** said. “An **extraordinary** one is a promise in **jeans**.” They spent the last of the month on **petrol** and a **processor**, and told the police exactly what they had spent and why the **loophole** mattered to a public **contract**. The deadline had been met; what it had cost them was the belief that a deadline is the hard part.

中文翻译

第四段弧线以一份合同和一场会议收尾。总主题是“一年的开幕”，中央公司的那位高管带着一个常规报价和一条非凡的建议到来：雇那位创立者，而不是承包商。警察就在门口，而那份录用附着一个白色信封。

协议里有一个漏洞：承包商可以在一次到访后离开，而采矿许可的安置被留给了总办公室。“我们总是知道最好的位置，从不知道价格，”那位随从说。汽油账单、处理器和牛仔裤的规格说明都在附件里。

傍晚，他们和警察、公司一起参加了一场纪念晚宴。“可以用一周时间做一块白色纪念碑，花一英镑买一个插头，”曼雅说，“功能性的部分就是没人拍照的那部分。”随后预算出现了一次收缩，阳台的设计不得不重做。

市场上的转变的确是倒闭的原因之一，但不是唯一的原因。“很多小的约定其实只是一个约定，”那位高管说，屋里的人注意到了冶铁炉下那张白纸。冶铁炉、花园和夜班，是旧计划留下的一切。

他们用三种语言做了一份小通告、一则广告和一份对估算的解释。那份对录用的接受，到来时比录用通知本身还短。“告诉他们，我们不是一个部门，”她说，“我们是一个位置、一个细节和一年的工作。”

总办公室在一周内回了信。它接受了合同，忽略了那个漏洞，并派了第二位随从到阳台，带着一个功能正常的插头和一份打印的估算。“常规报价是穿西装的承诺，”创立者说，“非凡的那一种是穿牛仔裤的承诺。”他们把那个剩下的钱花在汽油和一台处理器上，并如实告诉警察他们花了多少，以及那个漏洞为什么对一份公共合同至关重要。期限是赶上了；它让他们付出的代价，是“期限才是最难”这个信念。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
we wi: POS: pron	pron. 我们 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pl. of I; obj. The plural nominative case of the pronoun of the first; person; the word with which a person...
year jiə POS: n	n. 年, 年度, 年龄; [经] 年度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a period of time containing 365 (or 366) days; n. a period of time occupying a regular part of a calendar y...
leave li:v POS: n	n. 许可, 告别, 请假, 休假; vt. 离开, 剩下, 遗忘, 委托, 丢弃; vi. 出发, 离开, 生叶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the period of time during which you are absent from work or duty; n. permission to do something; v. go away...
night nait POS: n	n. 夜, 夜晚, 晚上, 黑暗, 夜晚的工作; [法] 夜, 黑夜, 黑暗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the time after sunset and before sunrise while it is dark outside; n. a period of ignorance or backwardness...
create kri:'eit POS: vt	vt. 创造, 建造, 引起, 任命 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. bring into existence; v. pursue a creative activity; be engaged in a creative activity; v. invest with a new...
position pə'ziʃən POS: n	n. 位置, 地位, 身分, 形势, 姿势, 立场, 职位, 状态, 阵地; vt. 安置, 决定...的位置; [计] 位置 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the particular portion of space occupied by something; n. a way of regarding situations or topics etc.; n. t...
detail 'di:teɪl POS: n	n. 细节, 详情; vt. 详述, 选派; vi. 画详图; [计] 详细数据 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an isolated fact that is considered separately from the whole; n. a small part that can be considered separ...
agreement ə'gri:mənt POS: n	n. 同意, 合约, 协议; [经] 契约, 协议, 协定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the statement (oral or written) of an exchange of promises; n. compatibility of observations; n. harmony of...
contract 'kɒntrækt POS: n	n. 合约, 婚约, 契约; vt. 使收缩, 使缩短, 感染, 订约, 缔结; vi. 皱缩, 订约, 收缩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a binding agreement between two or more persons that is enforceable by law; n. (contract bridge) the highes...
close kləʊz POS: n	n. 结束, 完结; a. 靠近的, 亲近的, 亲密的, 严密的, 关闭的, 狭窄的, 秘密的; vt. 关, 结束, 使靠近, 封闭, 使接... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. move so that an opening or passage is obstructed; make shut; v. become closed; v. finish or terminate (meeti...
design di'zeɪn POS: n	n. 设计, 图样, 方案, 企图; v. 设计, 计划 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of working out the form of something (as by making a sketch or outline or plan); n. an arrangement...
garden 'gɑ:dn POS: n	n. 花园, 果园, 菜园; vi. 栽培花木; vt. 造园; a. 花园的, 普通的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a plot of ground where plants are cultivated; n. the flowers or vegetables or fruits or herbs that are cult...
executive ig'zekjutɪv POS: n	n. 执行部门, 执行委员会, 执行者, 经理主管人员; a. 执行的, 善于执行的, 善于经营的; [计] 执行程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person responsible for the administration of a business; n. persons who administer the law; a. having the...
visit 'vɪzɪt POS: n	n. 拜访, 访问, 游览, 视察; vt. 拜访, 访问, 参观, 视察, 降临; vi. 访问, 参观, 闲谈 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of going to see some person or place or thing for a short time; n. a meeting arranged by the visito...
conference 'kɒnfərəns POS: n	n. 会议; [经] 会议, 讨论会, 协商会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a prearranged meeting for consultation or exchange of information or discussion (especially one with a for...
notice 'nəʊtɪs POS: n	n. 注意, 布告, 通知, 预告, 短评; vt. 注意, 通知, 评论, 提及, 关注; vi. 注意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an announcement containing information about an event; n. the act of noticing or paying attention; n. advanc...
explanation 'eksplə'neɪʃən POS: n	n. 解释, 说明, 辩解, 表明; [经] 解释, 注释, 说明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a statement that makes something comprehensible by describing the relevant structure or operation or circu...
overall 'əʊvəɹɔ:l POS: a	a. 全部的, 全体的, 从头至尾的, 一切在内的; adv. 从头到尾, 总的说来; n. 罩衫, 工作服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (usually plural) work clothing consisting of denim trousers (usually with a bib and shoulder straps); n. a...
theme θi:m POS: n	n. 主题, 话题, 题目 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a unifying idea that is a recurrent element in literary or artistic work; n. (music) melodic subject of a m...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
shift ʃɪft POS: n	n. 变化, 移动, 轮班, 手段, 应急办法, 移位; vt. 替换, 转移, 改变, 推卸, 变速; vi. 转换, 移动, 转变, 推托... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an event in which something is displaced without rotation; n. the time period during which you are at work; ...
opening ˈəʊpənɪŋ POS: n	n. 开始, 口子, 穴, 揭幕; a. 开始的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an open or empty space in or between things; n. a ceremony accompanying the start of some enterprise; n. bec...
ad æd POS: n	n. 广告; [计] 地址, 模拟-数字 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a public promotion of some product or service; r. in the Christian era; used before dates after the suppose...
estimate ˈestimeɪt POS: n	n. 估计, 判断; vt. 估计, 评价, 判断; vi. 估计 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an approximate calculation of quantity or degree or worth; n. a judgment of the qualities of something or s...
recommendation ˌrekəmenˈdeɪʃən POS: n	n. 推荐, 介绍, 推荐信, 劝告; [经] 建议书 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something (as a course of action) that is recommended as advisable; n. something that recommends (or expres...
conventional kənˈvenʃənəl POS: a	a. 传统的, 习惯的, 约定的; [经] 惯例的, 常规的, 传统的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. following accepted customs and proprieties; s. conforming with accepted standards; a. (weapons) using energy...
bid bɪd POS: n	n. 出价; v. 命令, 吩咐, 请求, 表示, 宣布, 投标 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an attempt to get something; n. a formal proposal to buy at a specified price; n. (bridge) the number of tri...
extraordinary ɪkˈstrɔːdnəri POS: a	a. 非常的, 特别的, 非凡的; [经] 非常的, 特别的, 临时的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. beyond what is ordinary or usual; highly unusual or exceptional or remarkable; s. far more than usual or ex...
founder ˈfaʊndə POS: n	n. 创立者, 建立者; vt. 使沉没, 使摔倒, 弄跛, 浸水, 破坏; vi. 沉没, 摔到, 变跛, 倒塌, 失败 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who founds or establishes some institution; n. a worker who makes metal castings; v. sink below the...
acceptance əkˈseptəns POS: n	n. 接受, 接纳, 承认, 同意, 赞同, 容忍, 相信; [经] 承兑, 认付, (工程)验收 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being acceptable and accepted; n. (contract law) words signifying consent to the terms of an o...
petrol ˈpetrəl POS: n	n. 汽油; [经] 汽油, 挥发油, 石油 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a volatile flammable mixture of hydrocarbons (hexane and heptane and octane etc.) derived from petroleum; u...
processor prəˈsesə POS: n	n. 信息处理机, 加工者, 处理者; [计] 处理器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a business engaged in processing agricultural products and preparing them for market; n. someone who proces...
jeans dʒiːnz POS: n	n. 工装裤, 牛仔褲 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n (usually plural) close-fitting trousers of heavy denim for manual work or casual wear; n a coarse durable tw...
specification ˌspesɪfɪˈkeɪʃən POS: n	n. 规格, 详述, 详细说明书; [计] 规范; 形式说明; 说明; 说明书; 规格 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a detailed description of design criteria for a piece of work; n. naming explicitly; n. (patent law) a docum...
functional ˈfʌŋkʃənəl POS: a	a. 功能的; [医] 机能的, 功能的, 官能的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. designed for or capable of a particular function or use; a. involving or affecting function rather than phy...
contractor ˈkɒntræktə POS: n	n. 立契约的人, 承包商; [化] 承包者; 承包工厂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone (a person or firm) who contracts to build things; n. the bridge player in contract bridge who wins...
engagement ɪnˈgeɪdʒmənt POS: n	n. 诺言, 约会, 婚约, 交战; [医] 衔接 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. employment for performers or performing groups that lasts for a limited period of time; n. contact by fitti...
memorial mɪˈmɔːriəl POS: n	n. 纪念物, 请愿书; a. 纪念的, 记忆的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a recognition of meritorious service; n. a written statement of facts submitted in conjunction with a petit...
mining ˈmaɪnɪŋ POS: n	n. 采矿; [经] 采矿, 采矿业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of extracting ores or coal etc from the earth; n. laying explosive mines in concealed places to des...
placement ˈpleɪsmənt POS: n	n. 放置, 布置, 工作安排, 编班, 定位球; [计] 放置 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the spatial property of the way in which something is placed; n. contact established between applicants and...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
forge fɔ:dʒ POS: n	n. 熔炉, 铁工厂; vt. 打制, 锻造, 伪造; vi. 锻造, 伪造 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. furnace consisting of a special hearth where metal is heated before shaping; n. a workplace where metal is...
balcony 'bælkəni POS: n	n. 阳台, 戏院楼厅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an upper floor projecting from the rear over the main floor in an auditorium; n. a platform projecting from...
attendant ə'tendənt POS: n	n. 随从, 侍者, 出席者; a. 侍候的, 伴随的, 出席的, 在场的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who waits on or tends to or attends to the needs of another; n. a person who is present and partici...
plug plʌg POS: n	n. 塞子, 栓, 插头; vt. 插入, 塞住, 接插头; vi. 被塞住 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. blockage consisting of an object designed to fill a hole tightly; n. an electrical device with two or three...
contraction kən'trækʃən POS: n	n. 收缩, 缩写式, 害病; [医] 收缩; 挛缩; 牙弓内缩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (physiology) a shortening or tensing of a part or organ (especially of a muscle or muscle fiber); n. a word...
loophole 'lu:pheul POS: n	n. 枪眼, 小窗, 换气孔 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an ambiguity (especially one in the text of a law or contract) that makes it possible to evade a difficult...